DESMOND MCDONAGH GOTO

Chicago, IL | gotodesmond@gmail.com | desmondgoto.github.io | substack.com/@desmondgoto | Dual US & EU Citizenship

SUMMARY

Recent Holy Cross graduate with experience in credit underwriting, EU policy and economic analysis, and published regulatory research. Analytical, detail-driven, and client-aware, with professional French and a strong international background.

EDUCATION

College of the Holy Cross, Worcester, MA — Bachelor of Arts, International Studies | May 2026
Concentrations: International Political Economy & Europe | Study Abroad: College Year in Athens | Dean's List, Both Semesters Senior Year | Academic All-American, Rugby
Relevant Coursework — *Quantitative:* Calculus I & II, Statistics. *Economics:* Principles of Economics, Economics of the European Union. *Political & International:* Introduction to International Relations, European Union Politics, Politics of Globalization, The Politics of Post-Communism, Evolution of Human Rights, Humanitarianism, Europe: Immigrants & Citizenship, The Making of the Modern Middle East II, Britain & Empire since 1901
Lycée Français de Chicago, Chicago, IL — International Baccalaureate Program
Founder, Investment Club | Varsity Rugby, Soccer, Basketball, Track & Field

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Policy and Economic Analyst — Center for Liberal Studies, Athens, Greece | May 2025 – May 2026
Part-time during senior year; full-time summer 2025

- Built and maintained a structured dataset evaluating 500+ EU directives across a 50-variable framework (energy, trade, financial regulation, shipping), verifying entries against EUR-Lex and official EU databases.
- Built Excel trackers monitoring policy and geopolitical risk indicators, keeping recurring macro-relevant data organized and current.
- Integrated AI tools into the research workflow to automate repetitive tasks and increase throughput; met recurring deadlines independently while carrying a full senior-year course load.

Junior Credit Analyst Intern — American Street Capital, Chicago, IL | June 2024 – August 2024

- Underwrote debt transactions ($750K–$50M) using Excel models to evaluate NOI, DSCR, LTV, borrower strength, and collateral quality across multifamily and commercial assets.
- Reviewed financial statements, rent rolls, and market comparables line by line, flagging inconsistencies before preparing credit analyses for senior staff.
- Sat in on client meetings and deal closing calls, gaining exposure to how documentation, funding, and settlement come together to close a transaction.

PUBLISHED RESEARCH

EU Regulatory Quality Index: Benchmarking EU legislation against regulatory quality standards — Centre for Liberal Studies – Markos Dragoumis (KEFiM), November 2025. Contributing researcher. desmondgoto.github.io/EU-Regulatory-Quality-Index.pdf

ACTIVITIES

Founder, Substack Publication — substack.com/@desmondgoto | 2026 – Present

- Publish independent analysis on macroeconomics, fixed income and equity markets, geopolitics, and global events, explaining what is moving markets and why to a public audience.

Member, Finance Club & Equity Research Club — College of the Holy Cross | Fall 2023 – May 2026

- Pitched ASML (September 2025), presenting the thesis on its EUV lithography monopoly, central role in global semiconductor supply chains, and asymmetric risk from export controls limiting Chinese access.

Equipment Manager & Leader, Rugby Football Club — College of the Holy Cross | August 2022 – May 2026

- Owned team equipment and logistics across a full season, coordinating schedules and communication for a large roster.

Founder & President, Investment Club — Lycée Français de Chicago | September 2020 – May 2022

SKILLS

Economics, Policy & Markets: Macroeconomics, international economics, EU regulatory framework, policy and impact-assessment analysis, credit markets, capital markets
Technical & Analytical: Advanced Excel (financial modeling, trackers, data checking), PowerPoint, Word, financial statement analysis, credit analysis, AI and LLM-assisted research workflows
Languages: English (native), French (professional proficiency), Greek (basic)